ELENA MINUCCI

elena.minucci@glasgow.ac.uk · elenaminucci.github.io

RESEARCH INTERESTS AND SKILLS

I am an interdisciplinary PhD candidate and teaching assistant at the University of Glasgow. I optimise persuasive conversational technologies based on each user's writing style. My research uses a combination of psycholinguistic feature extraction, LLM steering methods and collaborative filtering to deliver and dynamically update optimised writing styles.

My research interests include: Computational Modelling of Human Behaviour and Cognition · Persuasive AI · Automatic User Profiling · Conversational Interfaces · AI Personalisation · Computational Linguistics · Technology for Behaviour Change · Human-AI Interaction
My toolkit includes: R, Python, C++, NLP and LLM libraries (PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers), Bayesian modelling (Stan/brms/PyMC), Machine learning and local explainability (scikit-learn, SHAP), Data visualisation (ggplot2, matplotlib, seaborn), Git, LaTeX.

GRANTS

UKRI CDT Scholarship in Socially Intelligent Artificial Agents *2022-2027*
£87,229

UKRI Research Support and Training Grant *2022-2027*
£7,500

Strathclyde Business School Master Scholarship *2021-2022*
£5,000

EDUCATION

PhD in Computing Science and Psychology *2022-2027*
University of Glasgow
Thesis: Sustainable Me: A Persuasive Agent for Sustainability with Personalised Writing Style
Supervisors: Prof Simone Stumpf and Dr Martin Lages

MSc Marketing · Distinction *2021-2022*
University of Strathclyde

BA Hons Psychology · First Class *2015-2019*
University of Strathclyde

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

"It's a Bit of Me": Predicting Persuasion from Writing Style and Persuader-Receiver Similarity *2026*
E Minucci, S Stumpf, M Lages
Proceedings of the 34th ACM Conference on User Modeling, Adaptation and Personalization

Personalising persuasive technologies for behaviour change: a scoping review and research agenda *2026*
E Minucci, M Lages, S Stumpf
Interacting with Computers, Oxford University Press.

(Un)sustainable Personalities: the Role of Personality when Persuading to Adopt Sustainable Behaviours *2025*
Nominated for Best Paper Award
E Minucci, M Lages, S Stumpf

International Conference on Persuasive Technology, 299–314

Large language models in textual analysis for gesture selection *2023*
LB Hensel, N Yongsatianchot, P Torshizi, **E Minucci**, S Marsella
Proceedings of the 25th International Conference on Multimodal Interaction

TEACHING

Tutor - Psychology Level 2 *2023-Present*
University of Glasgow
Scientific Writing, Data Analysis, R & RStudio

Teaching Assistant - Multimedia Analysis and Design *2023-2024*
University of Glasgow
Web Design using HTML, CSS & JavaScript

SERVICE AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Research Group Organisation

Co-organiser of the Behaviour Change Lab group at the University of Glasgow. *2025-Present*

Journal Peer Review

For *Interacting with Computers*, Oxford University Press. *2026-Present*

Teaching Qualification

Developing as a Teacher in Higher Education (DAT HE) *2025*

OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

Marketing Co-Ordinator *2019-2020*
EGG Lighting
Managed the company's website showcasing the company's AI-integrated circular lighting fixtures.
Wrote business awards applications, one of which led to a mention for the company in a congratulatory motion in the Scottish Parliament.